JAMES CAMERON MITCHELL

Staff Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven and highly motivated Staff Engineer with a proven track record of spearheading cutting-edge technical initiatives and delivering actionable insights across mission-critical systems. Passionate about leveraging innovative solutions to champion cross-functional collaboration and synergistically drive organisational objectives through data-driven decision making. Dynamic technologist committed to establishing best practices and enabling teams to achieve transformational outcomes whilst maintaining focus on delivering measurable value and fostering a culture of technical excellence.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

TechVault Solutions Ltd

techvault.io

Glasgow, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led architecture and design of microservices infrastructure supporting 2 million daily active users, resulting in 40% improvement in system throughput and reduced latency from 800ms to 200ms average response time.

Established and championed cloud migration programme from on-premises data centre to AWS, directing 6-person team through planning, implementation and deployment phases whilst maintaining zero downtime for production systems.

Developed comprehensive technical standards and governance framework for backend services, including code review processes, testing requirements and deployment automation that increased deployment frequency from quarterly to daily releases.

Mentored 5 junior and mid-level engineers through structured technical development programme, guiding them on architectural patterns, system design and cloud-native technologies resulting in 3 promotions within 18 months.

Senior Software Engineer

Quantum Dynamics Ltd

quantumdynamics.co

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Designed and implemented distributed event streaming platform using Kafka and Apache Spark processing approximately 50 million events daily, enabling real-time analytics and reducing data pipeline latency by 65%.

Optimised PostgreSQL database query performance across legacy application by implementing proper indexing strategies and query rewriting, reducing average query time from 5 seconds to 300 milliseconds and cutting infrastructure costs by 35%.

Spearheaded migration of monolithic Java application to containerised microservices architecture using Docker and Kubernetes, enabling 8-person team to work independently whilst maintaining consistent deployment

processes across 12 services.

Implemented comprehensive observability stack incorporating Prometheus, Grafana and ELK for monitoring, logging and tracing that reduced mean time to resolution for production incidents from 2 hours to 15 minutes.

Software Engineer

Digital Forge Technologies

digitalforge.net

Glasgow, United Kingdom

January 2017 - May 2019

Developed REST API services in Python and Go serving as backbone for mobile application used by 500,000+ users, handling peak traffic of 10,000 requests per second with 99.95% uptime SLA.

Implemented comprehensive automated testing framework including unit tests, integration tests and end-to-end tests using pytest and Selenium that achieved 82% code coverage and reduced production bugs by 55%.

Optimised CI/CD pipeline using Jenkins and GitLab, reducing build times from 45 minutes to 8 minutes and enabling developers to deploy changes to production 8 times per day with increased confidence.

Collaborated with DevOps team to implement Infrastructure as Code using Terraform, managing AWS resources across development, staging and production environments whilst maintaining security and cost efficiency standards.

EDUCATION

University of Edinburgh

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Graduated: June 2016

GPA: 3.7/4.0

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, ECS, EKS), Google Cloud Platform

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Architecture and Design: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, System Design, Distributed Systems

DevOps and Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab

Data Processing: Apache Kafka, Apache Spark, Elasticsearch

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, New Relic, ELK Stack

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Agile Methodologies: Scrum, Kanban, Sprint Planning

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/jcmitchell/kafka-event-processor - Event streaming platform for real-time data processing using Kafka and Spark

github.com/jcmitchell/microservices-template - Boilerplate project demonstrating microservices architecture patterns in Go

github.com/jcmitchell/kubernetes-cost-optimizer - Tool for analysing and optimising Kubernetes resource utilisation and cloud costs

github.com/jcmitchell/distributed-cache-library - High-performance distributed caching library supporting Redis and Memcached backends